Executive Summary

On the 22nd of September 2026, an alert was triggered by an inbound email that contained what appeared to be a suspicious link to an Amazon delivery. From the very beginning, it read like a phishing email- the false sense of urgency to act within 48 hours, accompanied by a threat that the package would be sent back, and the domain being inconsistent with Amazon's official domains [figure1].

After investigating the alert, I found that the URL had been flagged as malicious by threat intelligence [figure2]; and firewall logs showed that the recipient of the email clicked on the URL, but the connection was blocked by the firewall [figure3 (a)]. This alert is therefore a True Positive.

My recommendation is to provide cybersecurity awareness training to the staff, remove the email from the recipient's inbox, and add the sender's address to the email blocklist.

Incident Details

Date and time of alert	22/09/2026, 18:11:55
Alert source	Email
Affected user	h.harris@thetrydaily.thm, 10.20.2.17
Alert type	Phishing

Investigation Timeline

The first thing I looked at was the suspicious link in the email. I performed a URL analysis to determine whether the particular link had been flagged as malicious and found that it had indeed been flagged as malicious [figure2].

Next, I had to determine whether the targeted recipient clicked on the link and if any connection was successfully established. This would provide a better understanding of whether the recipient's interaction with the link resulted in any successful outbound network activity. Upon analysing the firewall logs, I established that there had been an attempted outbound connection to the destination IP address 67.199.248[.]11; however, the firewall successfully blocked the connection [figure3 (a) & (b)]. I also checked if the sender had tried to target any other users within the network, and found that only H.Harris had been targeted [figure4]. Finally, I checked whether there had been any persistent phishing attempts targeting H. Harris and found none [figure5].

Evidence & Analysis

I ran a query that would show me only the values containing the URL, and the search returned one result, after which I performed a URL analysis that showed that the link was malicious [figure2].

Next, I looked at the firewall logs to determine whether a connection was established. I found that, although the user had clicked on the link, the firewall successfully blocked the connection in accordance with the firewall rules [figure3].

To determine whether any other users had been targeted, I filtered the search results by the sender's email address to identify all recipients. The results showed that only H. Harris had received an email from the sender. I then filtered the results by the URL, which confirmed that the link had also only been sent to H. Harris [Figure 4].

Indicators of Compromise

Type	Indicator	Context
Domain	Amazon[.]biz	Phishing sender’s domain
IPv4-addr	67.199.248[.]11	Destination IP of the phishing sender
URL	hxxp://bit[.]ly/3sHkX3da12340	Malicious link used in the phishing attack
Email	urgents@amazon[.]biz	Sender address that delivered the phishing email
Subject	Your Amazon Package Couldn’t Be Delivered – Action Required	The subject of the email that creates a false sense of urgency


```
{
  "type": "bundle",
  "id": "bundle--7f3c2a91-6d84-4b17-9e25-8a6d41c5b302",
  "objects": [
    {
      "type": "indicator",
      "spec_version": "2.1",
      "id": "indicator--935f5806-e930-4552-a8fd-d527708abbb2",
      "created": "2026-09-22T17:00:00.000Z",
      "modified": "2026-09-22T17:00:00.000Z",
      "name": "Phishing sender domain",
      "description": "Domain used by the sender of the phishing email.",
      "indicator_types": [
        "malicious-activity"
      ],
      "pattern": "[domain-name:value = 'amazon.biz']",
      "pattern_type": "stix",
      "valid_from": "2026-09-22T17:00:00.000Z"
    },
    {
      "type": "indicator",
      "spec_version": "2.1",
      "id": "indicator--ef71f50e-da76-48c3-981e-084f84ad9167",
      "created": "2026-09-22T17:00:00.000Z",
      "modified": "2026-09-22T17:00:00.000Z",
      "name": "Phishing sender IP address",
```

```
  "description": "IPv4 address associated with the phishing sender.",
  "indicator_types": [
    "malicious-activity"
  ],
  "pattern": "[ipv4-addr:value = '67.199.248.11']",
  "pattern_type": "stix",
  "valid_from": "2026-09-22T17:00:00.000Z"
},
{
  "type": "indicator",
  "spec_version": "2.1",
  "id": "indicator--e01dcca4-af0d-48c5-8fcb-bfa744ac239c",
  "created": "2026-09-22T17:00:00.000Z",
  "modified": "2026-09-22T17:00:00.000Z",
  "name": "Malicious phishing URL",
  "description": "URL contained in the phishing email.",
  "indicator_types": [
    "malicious-activity"
  ],
  "pattern": "[url:value = 'http://bit.ly/3sHkX3da12340']",
  "pattern_type": "stix",
  "valid_from": "2026-09-22T17:00:00.000Z"
},
{
  "type": "indicator",
  "spec_version": "2.1",
  "id": "indicator--badfd35c-db82-47fb-b4e8-10b2586f60d0",
  "created": "2026-09-22T17:00:00.000Z",
  "modified": "2026-09-22T17:00:00.000Z",
  "name": "Phishing sender email address",
  "description": "Email address that delivered the phishing email.",
  "indicator_types": [
    "malicious-activity"
  ],
```

```
    "pattern": "[email-addr:value = 'urgents@amazon.biz']",
    "pattern_type": "stix",
    "valid_from": "2026-09-22T17:00:00.000Z"
   }
 ]
}
```


Verdict & Severity

This alert is a True Positive. I'd classify the severity as medium because the alert involved an actual threat to the organisation. Had the firewall rules not been configured to block such websites, the attacker would've managed to infiltrate the system and move onto the next phase of the cyber kill chain.

Recommendations & Remediation

I recommend that cybersecurity awareness training be provided for staff on how to spot a phishing email and the dangers of clicking unknown links; remove the phishing email from the recipient's inbox; and add the sender's email address to the email blocklist. I'd also recommend that the network activity be closely monitored. Although the firewall blocked the connection, since the user clicked on the URL, it's crucial to look out for any signs of compromise going forward.

Screenshots

Figure1

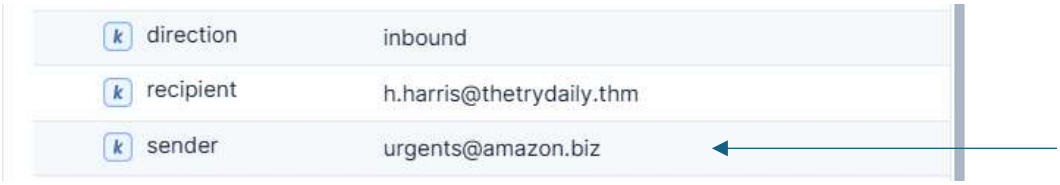


Figure2

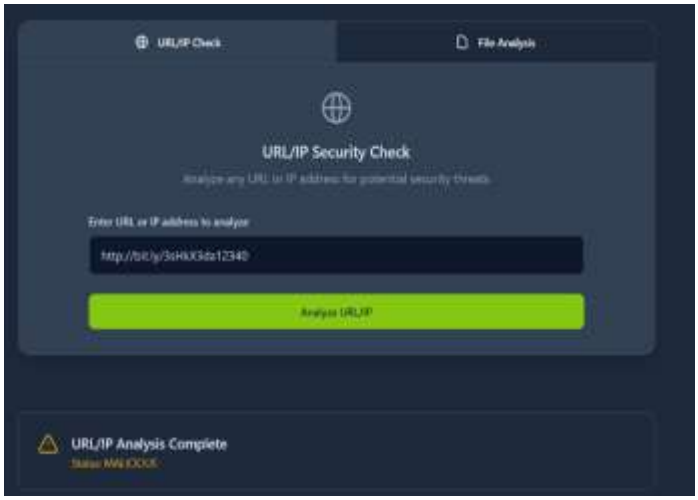


Figure3

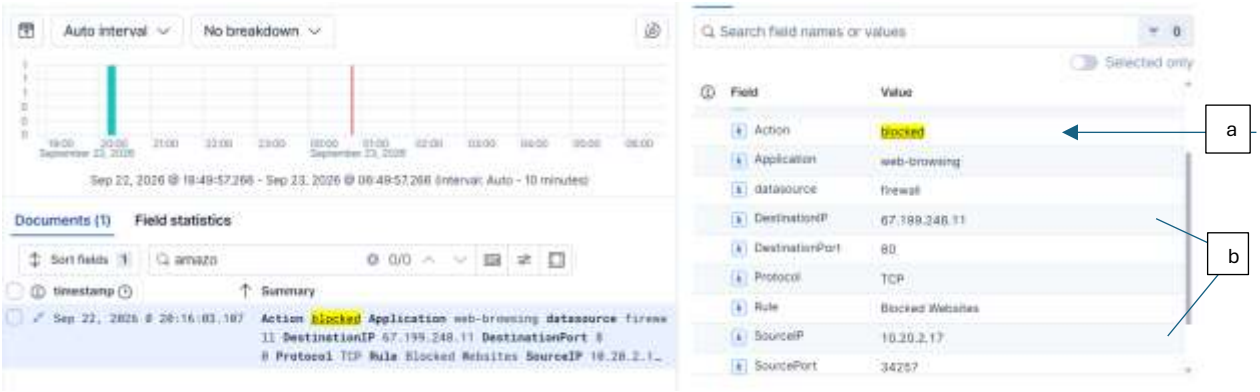


Figure4

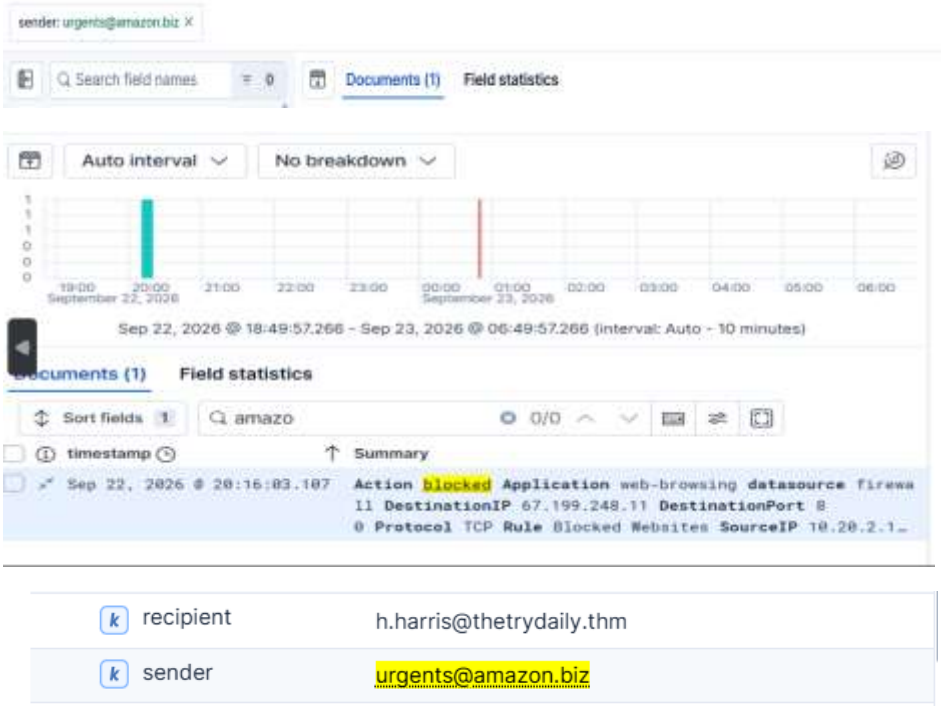


Figure5

